
Live overseas or live in the United States like a student (chapter 11)

Search out moneymaking sidelines (chapter 11)

Focus on spending priorities (chapter 11)

Norman M. Lobsenz, in a September 14, 1986, *Parade* article, says that during Edward Kennedy's first campaign for the Senate, he "was jeeringly described by an opponent as a man who never worked a day in his life. Next morning, when Kennedy solicited votes at a factory, one man shook his hand and referred to the jibe, saying, 'Don't worry, Ted. You ain't missed a thing.' "

As of this writing I've been retired for four years. I feel I haven't missed a thing. On the contrary, I still marvel at my good fortune. I have all the money I'll ever need. I have time to visit friends, invite Vicki out to breakfast, and take a siesta. If I want to work a political campaign, enroll in a two-month jazz course, take Vicki on a round-the-world junket, write a book, study Italy's economy, or build a vacation home, I simply go ahead and do it. I have my limits. I try to do only what I want to do. I won't drink wine coolers that smell like strawberry shortcake, for example, or try a new restaurant on New York's West Side that features a \$25 endive salad as a main course. But within reason, if I want to do something I do it.

Without the stress and anxiety I felt on the job, my disposition has improved. I see people in a different way. I think I'm more compassionate, more sympathetic to the needs of others. I growl only at people who truly deserve it, like New York cabdrivers, for example, and customs inspectors and French waiters. And I feel less hurried. Life has become a stroll through the park, with colorful flowers, freshly cut grass, and friendly faces, rather than a rush to get through the day's agenda.

What did I do to deserve my good life? I followed the rules in this book. But beyond the rules, I happened to have been